

COMMERCIAL OFFICE LEASE AGREEMENT

This Lease Agreement ("Lease") is entered into as of December 15, 2025, by and between Meridian Business Park LLC ("Landlord") and Halbrook & Associates, Inc. ("Tenant").

1. PREMISES Landlord leases to Tenant approximately 8,400 rentable square feet of office space located at 4100 Corporate Center Drive, Suite 220, Raleigh, NC 27612 ("Premises").

2. TERM The Lease Term shall commence on February 1, 2026 ("Commencement Date") and shall continue for a period of sixty (60) months, ending on January 31, 2031, unless earlier terminated as provided herein.

3. RENEWAL OPTION Tenant shall have one (1) option to renew this Lease for an additional term of thirty-six (36) months, provided Tenant gives Landlord written notice not less than one hundred eighty (180) days prior to the expiration of the initial Term. Tenant has not indicated an intention to exercise this option, and based on Tenant's current five-year growth plan discussed during lease negotiations, exercise of the renewal is not considered reasonably certain at this time.

4. BASE RENT Tenant shall pay Landlord Base Rent of Twenty-Two Thousand Four Hundred Dollars (\$22,400.00) per month, payable in advance on the first day of each calendar month, commencing on the Commencement Date.

5. RENT ESCALATION Base Rent shall increase by three percent (3%) on each annual anniversary of the Commencement Date throughout the Lease Term.

6. FREE RENT Tenant shall not be required to pay Base Rent for the first month of the Lease Term (February 2026) as a rent concession from Landlord.

7. SECURITY DEPOSIT AND INITIAL COSTS Tenant shall pay a security deposit of \$22,400.00 upon execution of this Lease. Tenant incurred legal fees of \$6,500 directly related to the negotiation and execution of this Lease, which shall be treated as initial direct costs of the Lease.

8. LEASE INCENTIVE Landlord shall provide Tenant a tenant improvement allowance of \$84,000.00 to be applied toward Tenant's build-out of the Premises, payable within 30 days of the Commencement Date.

9. OWNERSHIP AND PURCHASE OPTIONS This Lease does not transfer ownership of the Premises to Tenant at the end of the Lease Term, and Tenant has no option to purchase the Premises under this Lease.

10. USE OF PREMISES Tenant shall use the Premises solely for general office purposes.

11. DISCOUNT RATE This Lease does not state a rate implicit in the Lease. Tenant's incremental borrowing rate must be determined separately based on Tenant's own borrowing profile.

12. MAINTENANCE Landlord shall be responsible for maintenance of the building structure, roof, and common areas. Tenant shall be responsible for maintenance of the interior of the Premises.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, the parties have executed this Lease as of the date first written above.